

Create your first visualization

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

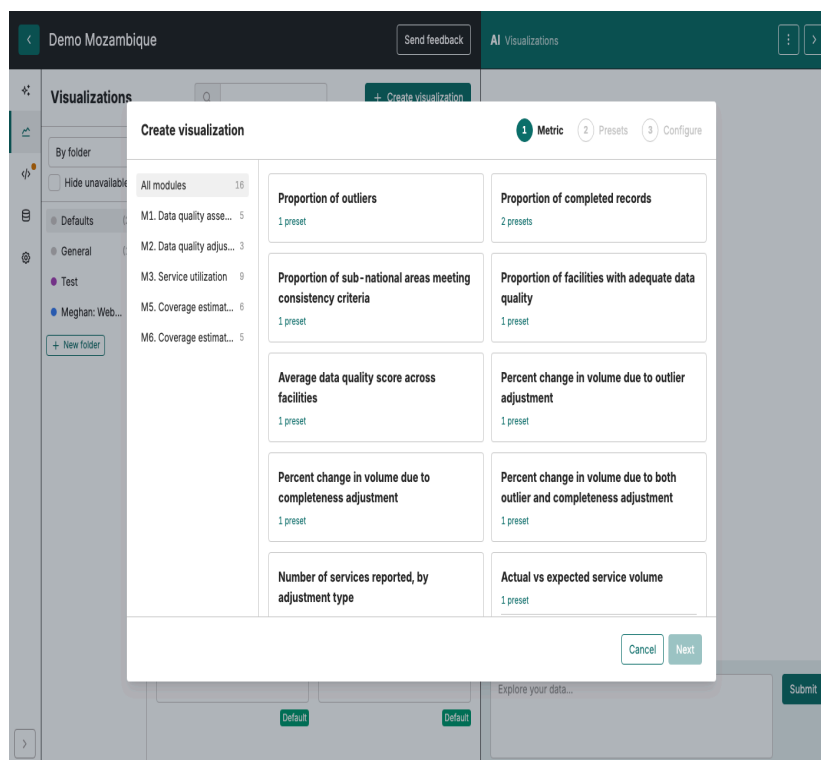
- ☐ You're signed in and looking at your country's project
- ☐ You're in the **Visualizations** tab
- ☐ You have a folder of your own (or you can use the shared one)

What you'll do

Create your first chart using the built-in builder: pick a **metric**, choose a **ready-made chart**, and it's saved to the project. You'll click through the builder yourself; the next activity does the same with the AI Assistant.

1 Open the visualization builder

In the Visualizations tab, click **Create visualization**. A three-step builder opens: **Metric** → **Presets** → **Configure**.



2 Pick a metric

Metrics are grouped by module on the left (M1. Data quality, M3. Service utilization, M4. Coverage...). A metric is **what is measured** — e.g. *Number of services reported, Actual vs expected service volume, Coverage*.

For a service-volume trend, open **M3. Service utilization** and pick a metric such as **Number of services reported**. Click **Next**.

3 Choose a ready-made chart

You'll see a grid of **presets** — ready-made charts. Choose **Service volume over time (monthly)** — a line chart of monthly volume by indicator. Click **Create**.

Your chart is created and appears in the **Visualizations** list. Use the **By folder** view to drop it into your folder.

The other presets give quarterly or annual **bar** charts. **Custom** → **Configure manually** lets you choose the chart type (table, time series, bar, map) and how to break the data down — see the next section.

Filter vs disaggregate — what's the difference?

These two words come up a lot. They are not the same:

- **Filter = pick what to show.** Choose the indicators, places, or months you want — only those appear. e.g. *show ANC1 only*, or *Northern region only*. Like a spotlight: you point it at what you want to see.
- **Disaggregate = break it down.** Split one total into its parts so you can compare them — e.g. *one line per indicator*, or *one bar per district*. Nothing is hidden; the total is shown as its pieces.

FILTER = choose what to show

All indicators are available

☐ ANC1

☐ ANC4

☐ BCG

☐ Penta



You picked ANC1 → only ANC1 shows

☒ ANC1

☐ ANC4

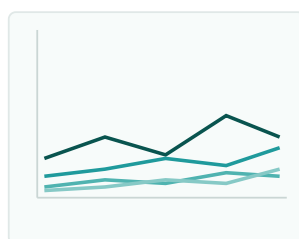
☐ BCG

☐ Penta

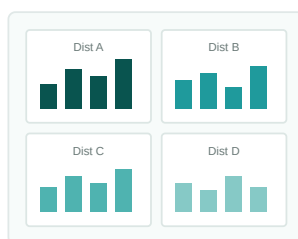
You pick what you want to see.

Whatever you don't tick simply isn't shown — like a spotlight.

DISAGGREGATE “ANC1 by district” — four ways to display the parts



Lines
one line per district



Grid
a mini chart for each

District	Visits
Dist A	900
Dist B	850
Dist C	1,000
Dist D	800

Rows
one row per district

Dist A	Dist B	Dist C	Dist D
900	850	1,000	800

Columns
one column per district

Example. Start with *total ANC1 visits, nationally*. **Filter** to "Northern region" → now you see only Northern's ANC1. **Disaggregate** "by district" → the same total split into one bar (or line) per district.

Where you do this when you edit a viz

Open a saved visualization — the controls live in the **left panel**, and you'll often need to **scroll down** to find them (this is where people get lost). Two sections do the work:

- **Filter (subset)** — **pick what you want to see**: set the time period, and tick the indicator(s) you want. Only what you tick appears.
- **Display (disaggregate)** — choose **how the parts are shown**. The dropdown gives four options:
 - **Lines** — one line per part, all on the same chart
 - **Grid** — a separate little chart for each part, side by side
 - **Rows** — one table row per part
 - **Columns** — one table column per part

Data	Presentation	Text
Metric Actual vs expected service volume		
Presentation type Timeseries		
Filter (subset) ☐ Data values ☒ Time period ☒ Last N months ☐ From specific month to present ☐ Last N full calendar years ☐ Last N full calendar quarters ☐ Custom Number of months = 12 <input type="range"/>		
☒ Indicator ANC1 ANC4 BCG DELIVERY OPD PENTA1 PENTA3 PNC1_MOTHER PNC1_NEWBORN		
Display (disaggregate) ☒ Data values (Required for this visualization) Lines		

Watch out when you use both together. Here's the trap, with an example. You split a chart **by district** because you want to compare the districts. Then you **filter** it down to just one district — so the others disappear. Now you're looking at a single district on its own, and there's nothing left to compare.

The simple rule: use **filter** to pick the data you want to look at, and use **disaggregate** to split it into the parts you want to compare. Just don't filter down to only one of the things you wanted to compare.

Try a few options

Repeat with a different metric or preset — a coverage metric under **M4**, or the quarterly-change bar chart — to see how each reads.

Tip: Line charts (*Service volume over time*) are best for trends over time. Bar charts (*quarterly / annual change*) are better for comparing periods or places. The reference handout *How to read a FASTR visualization* goes deeper.

Check yourself

You should now have:

- At least one chart created and visible in your **Visualizations** list
- The path in muscle memory: **Create visualization** → **Metric** → **Presets** → **Create**
- A sense of which presets suit trends vs comparisons

What's next

The next activity does the same thing using the AI Assistant — typing a request in plain language instead of clicking through the builder. Same end result, different path.

 **Verify in your current UI:** labels (*Create visualization*, *Create*) may differ slightly. The **Metric** → **Presets** → **Create** path is the key structure.